

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 49)

Page 242 - The Victorian Novel

Q1. The Victorian novel is described as an index of the many-sided interests and conflicting elements of what age?

- A. The Elizabethan age
- B. The Romantic age
- C. The Victorian age
- D. The Modern age

Answer: C

Q2. What well-marked tendency in Victorian fiction is noted, leading to subdivision of labour and interests?

- A. Generalisation
- B. Specialisation
- C. Romanticisation
- D. Classical imitation

Answer: B

Q3. According to the text, the subdivision of the novel frequently followed what kinds of lines?

- A. Chronological lines
- B. Geographical lines (Irish, Scottish, English counties)
- C. Astronomical lines
- D. Strictly historical lines

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Answer: B

Q4. It is largely through these subdividing tendencies that prose fiction has become practically coextensive with what?

- A. All classical philosophy
- B. All poetic forms
- C. All aspects and activities of the modern world
- D. Religious history only

Answer: C

Q5. Who are the three chief novelists of the Victorian time mentioned as the primary focus of the survey?

- A. Dickens, Thackeray, and George Eliot
- B. Austen, Scott, and Brontë
- C. Hardy, Meredith, and Stevenson
- D. Fielding, Smollett, and Richardson

Answer: A

Q6. In what year did Charles Dickens spring suddenly into fame with the Pickwick Papers?

- A. 1825
- B. 1832
- C. 1837
- D. 1845

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Answer: C

Q7. At what age did Charles Dickens find himself the most popular of English novelists?

- A. Twenty
- B. Twenty-five
- C. Thirty
- D. Thirty-five

Answer: B

Q8. Charles Dickens began as a follower of the traditions of which earlier novelist, whom he had read as a child?

- A. Samuel Richardson
- B. Henry Fielding
- C. Tobias Smollett
- D. Laurence Sterne

Answer: C

Q9. Dickens's early novels like *Pickwick* and *Nicholas Nickleby* are described as what?

- A. Tight, coherent psychological dramas
- B. Bundles of adventures connected only by characters
- C. Strict historical allegories
- D. Highly structured tragedies

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Answer: B

Q10. Which period's social significance of prose fiction was pointed out in earlier sections?

A. Seventeenth century

B. Eighteenth century

C. Nineteenth century

D. Renaissance

Answer: B

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Page 243 - Charles Dickens

Q1. Which of Dickens's novels is said to open his second period due to its systematic attempt at a coherent plot?

- A. Pickwick Papers
- B. David Copperfield
- C. Bleak House
- D. Oliver Twist

Answer: C

Q2. In what years was Bleak House published?

- A. 1837-38
- B. 1849-50
- C. 1852-53
- D. 1864-65

Answer: C

Q3. Despite changing his structural method, what element is still present in Dickens's later books like Little Dorrit and Great Expectations?

- A. A complete absence of plot
- B. A great deal of merely episodic material
- C. Exclusively upper-class settings

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D. Historical allegory

Answer: B

Q4. In what field did Dickens's great achievements in characterisation largely lie?

A. The historical and epic

B. The odd and the grotesque

C. The subtle and the realistic

D. The classical and proportional

Answer: B

Q5. What is admitted about Dickens's characterisation?

A. It was totally realistic

B. Character was generally heightened into caricature

C. He lacked descriptive power

D. He could not write humorous characters

Answer: B

Q6. To which other writer in English literature is Dickens compared in terms of creating so many men and women who have become permanent elements of humorous tradition?

A. Chaucer

B. Shakespeare

C. Milton

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D. Pope

Answer: B

Q7. What was considered Dickens's principal fault?

A. The over-wrought quality of much of his emotion

B. A complete lack of humor

C. Insufficient vocabulary

D. His cynical view of life

Answer: A

Q8. What genre did Dickens love, which often became too theatrical in his work?

A. Tragedy

B. Epic poetry

C. Melodrama

D. Satire

Answer: C

Q9. Dickens's novels belong entirely to which movement of the Victorian era?

A. The Oxford Movement

B. The Pre-Raphaelite Movement

C. The humanitarian movement

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D. The Aesthetic Movement

Answer: C

Q10. How is Dickens described in relation to his themes from first to last?

A. An objective historian

B. A novelist with a purpose

C. A cynical satirist

D. A romantic poet

Answer: B

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Page 244 - Dickens and Thackeray

Q1. Through his enormous popularity, what did Dickens's humanitarianism make him?

- A. A wealthy aristocrat
- B. One of the greatest social reformers of his age
- C. A member of Parliament
- D. A religious leader

Answer: B

Q2. Despite recognizing the many evils of the world, what attitude did Dickens maintain?

- A. Profound melancholy
- B. Unwavering optimism
- C. Deep cynicism
- D. Indifference

Answer: B

Q3. In contrast to Dickens's world of the lower classes, what was the world of William Makepeace Thackeray?

- A. The rural peasantry
- B. 'Society'?the clubs, drawing rooms, and the well-to-do
- C. The industrial working class
- D. The criminal underworld

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Answer: B

Q4. What is the title of Thackeray's first really successful and most characteristic book?

- A. Pendennis
- B. Henry Esmond
- C. Vanity Fair
- D. The Newcomes

Answer: C

Q5. Where did the phrase 'Vanity Fair' originate?

- A. The Bible
- B. Pilgrim's Progress
- C. Paradise Lost
- D. The Faerie Queene

Answer: B

Q6. What is the sub-title of Vanity Fair, which points to the foundation principles of his art?

- A. A Tale of Two Cities
- B. A Novel without a Hero
- C. A Story of English Society
- D. A Satire of the Age

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Answer: B

Q7. Thackeray was essentially a social satirist and a what?

- A. Romanticist
- B. Idealist
- C. Realist
- D. Mystic

Answer: C

Q8. Thackeray's attacks upon snobbery and humbug parallel the denunciations of which great moral teacher?

- A. John Ruskin
- B. Matthew Arnold
- C. Thomas Carlyle
- D. John Stuart Mill

Answer: C

Q9. Why did Thackeray consciously rupture with romanticism in fiction?

- A. He found it too difficult to write
- B. He believed it gave a totally false impression of life and did immense harm
- C. He wanted to imitate French novelists
- D. He thought it was too political

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Answer: B

Q10. In reacting against the romantic tradition, what did Thackeray practically make the pith and substance of his stories?

- A. Vice rather than virtue
- B. Virtue rather than vice
- C. Historical fact rather than fiction
- D. Poetry rather than prose

Answer: A

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Page 245 - Thackeray and George Eliot

Q1. Which of Thackeray's books deals almost exclusively with the sordid and ugly aspects of life?

- A. Vanity Fair
- B. The Newcomes
- C. Barry Lyndon
- D. Henry Esmond

Answer: C

Q2. What element gained in prominence and importance in Thackeray's works after Vanity Fair (e.g., in Pendennis, Esmond)?

- A. The good element (purity and unselfishness)
- B. The supernatural element
- C. The criminal element
- D. The rural element

Answer: A

Q3. How is Thackeray's general view of existence described, in contrast with Dickens's?

- A. Profoundly optimistic
- B. Profoundly melancholy
- C. Scientifically detached
- D. Mystically joyous

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Answer: B

Q4. What phrase states the text of Thackeray's many moralisings?

- A. Carpe diem
- B. Vanitas vanitatum
- C. Amor vincit omnia
- D. Memento mori

Answer: B

Q5. In what was Thackeray's interest always centred?

- A. Character
- B. Complex plot construction
- C. Historical accuracy
- D. Natural description

Answer: A

Q6. Which of Thackeray's novels is considered one of the very finest historical novels in the language, recreating the early eighteenth century?

- A. Pendennis
- B. The Virginians
- C. Henry Esmond
- D. Philip

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Answer: C

Q7. What was the pen-name of Mary Ann (or Marian) Evans?

- A. Currer Bell
- B. George Eliot
- C. Mary Ann Cotton
- D. Mrs. Gaskell

Answer: B

Q8. In the hands of George Eliot, what did the novel become?

- A. Strictly comedic
- B. Moral and philosophical
- C. Purely adventurous
- D. Exclusively satirical

Answer: B

Q9. What world did George Eliot mostly depict in her novels?

- A. London street life
- B. The clubs of the well-to-do
- C. Old-fashioned provincial life
- D. Ancient classical societies

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Answer: C

Q10. In which novel did George Eliot make an excursion into the past? a tale of the Renaissance in Florence?

A. Adam Bede

B. The Mill on the Floss

C. Silas Marner

D. Romola

Answer: D

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Page 246 - George Eliot

Q1. George Eliot's work superficially resembles that of which earlier writer in its representation of men and manners in country towns?

- A. Charlotte Brontë
- B. Jane Austen
- C. Ann Radcliffe
- D. Fanny Burney

Answer: B

Q2. Unlike Jane Austen, what was George Eliot concerned with beneath the surface of seemingly dull existence?

- A. Political intrigue
- B. Great moral struggles
- C. Financial ambition
- D. Artistic achievement

Answer: B

Q3. With her power of weaving poignant tragedy out of home-spun materials, George Eliot is described as an exponent of what movement in literature?

- A. The aristocratic movement
- B. The democratic movement
- C. The aesthetic movement

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D. The neo-classical movement

Answer: B

Q4. Which character's pitiful story in Adam Bede is cited as an example of George Eliot weaving tragedy out of home-spun materials?

A. Maggie Tulliver

B. Hetty Sorrel

C. Silas Marner

D. Dorothea Brooke

Answer: B

Q5. What distinctive philosophic element in George Eliot's work connects her with the tendencies of her age?

A. Mysticism

B. Scientific tendencies

C. Romantic idealism

D. Strict orthodoxy

Answer: B

Q6. What unique quality did George Eliot bring to her novels, beginning her career late in life?

A. Scholarship such as no other English writer of fiction had possessed

B. Experience as a member of Parliament

C. Training as a professional actor

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D. Background as a sailor

Answer: A

Q7. George Eliot's novels are described not as light literature but as great what?

A. Scientific treatises

B. Essays on life

C. Historical chronicles

D. Political pamphlets

Answer: B

Q8. What was habitually the central theme of George Eliot's works?

A. The conflict between science and religion

B. The conflict between the higher and the lower life (duty and inclination)

C. The struggle for wealth

D. The tension between England and France

Answer: B

Q9. What movement in the story commonly made George Eliot's books profoundly sad?

A. The movement from poverty to wealth

B. The movement from weakness to sin and from sin to nemesis

C. The movement from youth to old age

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D. The movement from ignorance to education

Answer: B

Q10. What tendency, which grew upon her as her creative faculty waned, proved extremely detrimental to George Eliot's posthumous fame?

A. The excessive use of dialogue

B. The excessive use of analysis and commentary

C. The total lack of structure

D. The complete reliance on historical documents

Answer: B